

CAMERAS

MEGAPIXEL COUNT



You'd think everyone would have gotten over this by now. However, it's like each new tech buyer generation that comes along every seven years or so, needs a re-education. The biggest myth perpetuated in the camera category is that a bigger megapixel count means a better camera. This is not true at all! Sensors matter, and it's why even an 8



Digital camera sensor sizes.

megapixel dedicated camera can outperform an 18 megapixel smartphone camera. There are a number of sensor sizes available in digital cameras. The compromise is usually between portability and

image quality. Even within the same sensor size range, a higher megapixel count is no guarantee of a better image quality. Often, in mid-range and point-and-shoot cameras, the actual sensor size is not mentioned. This means that users are often fooled into buying a camera with a smaller sensor size with a large megapixel count, instead of a camera with a larger sensor size.

DIGITAL ZOOM



Again, something we'd hope everyone already knows, but yet we see many people still falling for this old trick. In order to show-off zoom functionality, many manufacturers focus on a higher digital zoom number instead of a lower optical zoom. Honestly, we think it's time that all manufacturers got together and banned this functionality forever. All a digital zoom does is zoom into an image, much like you do in an image editing software. It adds no more im-



It is better to have no digital zoom at all.

age information, and usually just results in very pixelated images. Besides, your PC has far more processing power than your camera, and would do a far better job of zooming into the image. Just never use digital zoom, ever!

LAPTOPS / PCs

VR READY PSU



With VR becoming more mainstream, a whole new marketing term has become available to PC and laptop manufacturers, and boy are they using it. Now, of course, there are legitimate claims to be made here. For instance, you do actually need a GPU or CPU that's capable or meets popular VR platform's requirements. A case can also be made for cabinets (pun intended) because they add in extra front USB slots or something... and we can definitely look the other way when



Must be VR Ready if the box says so

headsets claim to be VR compatible, because they need to fit with the VR head-mounted display. However, not wanting to be left behind, power supply manufacturers are now claiming "VR Ready" status. Five whole turds for you sirs, for doing absolutely nothing new but pretending to have done so. What's next? VR ready keyboards, mice, printers, scanners, routers, cabinet lights, etc.? Make sure you don't pay extra for this steaming load of excreta!

BATTERY LIFE



Loving your brand new laptop? Why shouldn't you? So much in love are you that you decide to take her (yes, we think of laptops as female, and gaming PCs as male) down to the local park to sit under a tree and live the hippie dream, while still staying connected to the net – where all your friends live. So you cough your way through the smog and traffic and spend an hour commuting to the closest park in one of our major cities, and then sit down hoping to spend a couple of hours pretending you are in a jungle, when a mere 45 minutes later you see the low battery warning. "WTF!" you exclaim, "I thought you said you